Riverside General Hospital — Nursing Policy NUR-207
Central Line Dressing Change and Bundle Maintenance (ICU)

Scope: Applies to Registered Nurses (RN) caring for patients with central venous catheters in the Intensive Care Unit.
Reference: CDC Guidelines for the Prevention of Intravascular Catheter-Related Infections; Joint Commission NPSG.07.04.01.

Shift Start — Patient Bedside
1. RN: Perform hand hygiene with alcohol-based rub for at least 20 seconds before touching the line.
2. Assess the insertion site for redness, swelling, or drainage and document findings.
3. Measure and record the patient's temperature. If temperature is greater than 38.3 C, notify the attending physician immediately.

Dressing Change — Every 7 days or when soiled
4. Don sterile gloves and a mask. CAUTION: Maintain sterile field throughout; do not touch the catheter hub with non-sterile hands.
5. Scrub the site with 2% chlorhexidine gluconate for 30 seconds and allow to air dry completely.
6. Apply a new transparent semi-permeable dressing and label it with date, time and your initials.
7. Photograph the new dressing for the wound-care record.

Medication Line Check — Every 4 hours
8. Charge Nurse and RN: Perform an independent double-check of any high-alert infusion (heparin, insulin) connected to the line.
9. Record the infusion pump rate in mL/hr.

Shift End — Nurses' Station
10. Enter the central line lot number and catheter day count into the EHR.